

DIGITAL FORENSICS

BROWSER & LNK ARTIFACT ANALYSIS

CYBERSTER — WEEK 9 TASK REPORT
Days 60–66 | Browser Forensics & LNK File Analysis

Scope	Browser History • Downloads • Cookies • Cache • LNK Artifacts
Tools Used	Hindsight, LECmd, Timeline Explorer
Classification	Student Forensic Report – Not for Distribution
Verdict	No Malicious Activity Detected

01 | Browser History Analysis

The browser history analysis revealed frequent activity across multiple platforms, including ChatGPT, WhatsApp Web, Google, anime streaming websites (e.g., 9anime, Mangafire), and development-related resources.

Timestamp analysis indicates consistent browsing behaviour with increased activity during recent days. High visit counts for platforms such as ChatGPT and WhatsApp Web suggest regular usage for communication and productivity, while visits to streaming platforms indicate recreational activity.

No evidence of access to known malicious or explicitly harmful websites was identified. However, repeated interaction with third-party streaming platforms introduces potential risk due to advertisements and unverified content sources.

Overall Assessment: The browsing behaviour reflects a combination of productive and entertainment activities, with no strong indicators of compromise.

Evidence Screenshots

#	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
	id	url	title	visit_count	typed_count	last_visit_time_readable	domain						
2	2	https://www	Templates - Canva	0	0		canva						
3	3	https://web	WhatsApp Web	5	0	4/20/2026 7:23	web						
4	23	https://cha	ChatGPT	62	8	4/28/2026 4:46	chatgpt						
5	214	https://cha	ChatGPT	97	47	4/27/2026 16:48	chatgpt						
6	1226	https://stea	Steam Workshop::PositivePressure's	0	0		steamcommunity						
7	1416	https://ww	Webstack - Creator portfolio website	0	0		framer						
8	1419	https://fraf	Webstack (copy) â€œ Framer	0	0		framer						
9	1452	https://fraf	Webstack (copy) â€œ Framer	0	0		framer						
10	1456	https://hoo	Andrew Scott Expert Web Designer	0	0		hopeful-signposts-430966						
11	2191	https://ww	Career Opportunities at SentinelOne	0	0		sentinelone						
12	3169	https://ww	SV!%Welcome! - Cyber Foundations	0	0		skool						
13	3481	https://ww	(1) Notifications LinkedIn	10	0	4/24/2026 6:27	linkedin						
14	3545	https://ww	Virtual Security job simulations Fora	0	0		theforage						
15	3586	https://ww	Presentation Intelligence	0	0		pi						
16	4078	https://tra	Training Institute: Library Training In	0	0		training						
17	4130	https://blu	BTLO	0	0		blueteamlabs						
18	4362	https://aca	Modules	0	0		academy						
19	4474	https://acc	Sign In - Google Accounts	3	0	4/19/2026 15:05	accounts						
20	4929	https://try	TryHackMe Defending Azure Trainin	0	0		tryhackme						
21	4956	https://sup	Our Free Courses â€œ Security Blue Te	0	0		support						

Figure 1 – Hindsight Browser History View

DB Browser for SQLite - C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\Forensics\Browser\Default\History

File Edit View Tools Help

New Database Open Database Write Changes Revert Changes Undo Open Project Save Project Attach Database Close Database

Database Structure Browse Data Edit Pragma Execute SQL

Table: urls

	id	url	title	visit_count	typed_count	last_visit_time	hidden
	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter
1	2	https://www.canva.com/	Templates - Canva	0	0		0
2	3	https://web.whatsapp.com/	WhatsApp Web	5	0	1342114343309537	
3	23	https://chatgpt.com/?oai-dm=1	ChatGPT	62	8	13421825219325050	
4	214	https://chatgpt.com/	ChatGPT	97	47	13421782088335323	
5	1226	https://steamcommunity.com/...	Steam Workshop::PositivePressure's ...	0	0		0
6	1416	https://www.framer.com/marketplace/...	Webstack - Creator portfolio website...	0	0		0
7	1419	https://framer.com/projects/...	Webstack (copy) - Framer	0	0		0
8	1452	https://framer.com/projects/Webstack...	Webstack (copy) - Framer	0	0		0
9	1456	https://hopeful-...	Andrew Scott Expert Web Designer &...	0	0		0
10	2191	https://www.sentinelone.com/careers/	Career Opportunities at SentinelOne:...	0	0		0
11	3169	https://www.skool.com/cybersec/...	Welcome! - Cyber Foundations ...	0	0		0
12	3481	https://www.linkedin.com/...	(1) Notifications LinkedIn	10	0	13421485631468380	
13	3545	https://www.theforage.com/...	Virtual Security job simulations ...	0	0		0
14	3586	https://www.pi.inc/docs/...	Presentation Intelligence	0	0		0
15	4078	https://training.fortinet.com/local/...	Training Institute: Library ...	0	0		0
16	4130	https://blueteamlabs.online/home/...	BTLO	0	0		0

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Go to: 1

UTF-8

Figure 2 – Browser Data Overview

DB Browser for SQLite - C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\Forensics\Browser\Default\History

File Edit View Tools Help

New Database Open Database Write Changes Revert Changes Undo Open Project Save Project Attach Database Close Database

Database Structure Browse Data Edit Pragma Execute SQL

Table: visits

	id	url	visit_time	from_visit	external_referrer_url	transition	segment_id	visit_duration	incremented_omnib
	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter	Filter
1	74123	30420	13414157147503580	74124		805306368	0	0	
2	74124	31375	13414157145647531	0		838860805	0	1864693	
3	74125	20391	13414150577871530	74128		805306368	0	0	
4	74126	7147	13414150577215371	74128		805306368	0	659713	
5	74127	7148	13414150576472529	74128		805306368	0	746083	
6	74128	7150	13414150574900834	74129		805306368	0	1578870	
7	74129	7145	13414150566336920	0		805306370	0	8572309	
8	74130	16024	13414149303743995	0		822083584	0	0	
9	74131	31376	13414149302909394	0		822083584	0	840189	
10	74132	31377	13414149302329492	0		822083584	0	586447	
11	74133	31378	13414149299037573	0		805306368	0	3298425	
12	74134	31377	13414149297537119	0		822083584	0	1507593	
13	74135	31379	13414149289516119	0		805306368	0	8027961	
14	74136	31377	13414149288481102	0		822083584	0	1042627	
15	74137	31380	13414149286122607	0		805306368	0	2365639	
16	74138	31377	13414149283905708	0		805306368	0	2224091	

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Go to: 1

UTF-8

Figure 3 – Visit Time Distribution

A	B	C	D	E	F	G
domain	visit_count	last_visit_time				
9anime	290	4/30/2026 4:46				
claude	242	4/30/2026 12:52				
google	88	4/30/2026 12:14				
boringegotistical	85	4/29/2026 8:44				
mangafire	55	4/29/2026 8:44				
bioaqua	31	4/30/2026 6:28				
w7	17	4/28/2026 18:34				
b7510	13	4/28/2026 18:12				
docs	10	4/30/2026 7:09				
easypaia	7	4/29/2026 5:15				

Figure 4 – Top 10 Domains Visited

02 | Downloads Analysis

The download history analysis identified a variety of file types, including documents, images, and compressed or executable files.

Normal Activity

Downloads of PDFs, images, and document files indicate typical user behaviour, such as accessing study material, saving images, and working with documents. These file types are consistent with normal usage and present low risk.

- PDF and text document downloads — study/work related
- Image files — consistent with content viewing
- Standard document formats — low risk

Suspicious Indicators

Certain entries require further attention due to the presence of **.exe** and **.zip** files, entries with missing or unclear extensions, and file paths that no longer exist on disk.

- .exe files — may represent installation files (legitimate or potentially unsafe)
- .zip archives from external sources — require manual inspection
- Missing file entries — suggest post-download deletion or execution

Assessment

No confirmed malicious files were identified. Executable and compressed files should be verified, and missing file entries may indicate post-download activity.

Evidence Screenshots

The screenshot shows the DB Browser for SQLite application interface. The title bar indicates the database is located at C:\Users\Ali Rayaan\Desktop\Forensics\Browser\Default\History. The menu bar includes File, Edit, View, Tools, and Help. The toolbar contains buttons for New Database, Open Database, Write Changes, Revert Changes, Undo, Open Project, Save Project, Attach Database, and Close Database. The main window is divided into three tabs: Database Structure, Browse Data, and Edit Pragma, with Execute SQL also visible. The 'Table:' dropdown is set to 'downloads'. The table view shows a list of file records with columns for 'last_modified' and 'mime_type'. The table has three main sections: a filter section, a 'last_modified' section, and a 'mime_type' section. The data is as follows:

	Filter	last_modified	Filter	mime_type	Filter	original_mime_type
1		Fri, 20 Sep 2024 12:56:13 GMT		application/x-msdownload		application/octet-stream
2				application/x-zip-compressed		application/zip
3				application/x-zip-compressed		application/zip
4				application/x-zip-compressed		application/x-zip-compressed
5				application/x-zip-compressed		application/zip
6		Thu, 17 Oct 2024 11:39:19 GMT		application/x-msdownload		application/x-msdownload
7				application/x-msdownload		application/x-msdownload
8		Thu, 13 Feb 2025 07:00:10 GMT		application/x-msdownload		application/octet-stream
9				application/vnd.openxmlformats-...		application/vnd.openxmlformats-...
10				application/vnd.openxmlformats-...		application/vnd.openxmlformats-...
11				application/vnd.openxmlformats-...		application/vnd.openxmlformats-...
12				application/vnd.openxmlformats-...		application/vnd.openxmlformats-...
13				application/vnd.openxmlformats-...		application/vnd.openxmlformats-...
14				application/vnd.openxmlformats-...		application/vnd.openxmlformats-...
15				application/pdf		application/pdf
16				application/vnd.openxmlformats-...		application/vnd.openxmlformats-...

The status bar at the bottom shows '1 - 16 of 1,055' and a 'Go to:' field with the value '1'. The bottom right corner indicates the encoding is UTF-8.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
	state	interrupt_r	tab_url	mime_type	start_time_readable	end_time_readable	filename
1	1	0	https://www...	application/x-msdownload	3/7/2025 5:46	3/7/2025 5:46	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\mediacreationtool.exe
2	1	0	https://github.com/...	application/x-zip-compressed	3/9/2025 13:20	3/9/2025 13:20	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\interview_coach_GPT-4-main.zip
3	1	0	https://github.com/...	application/x-zip-compressed	3/9/2025 13:20	3/9/2025 13:20	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\HomeServices-SoftwareGraduatedP
4	1	0	file:///M:/...	application/x-zip-compressed	3/10/2025 17:06	3/10/2025 17:06	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\KMSPico_Install-10.2.0.zip
5	1	0	https://github.com/...	application/x-zip-compressed	3/10/2025 17:06	3/10/2025 17:06	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\abcc26792f0875582bc2cd64c50a3c
6	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/15/2025 8:13	3/15/2025 8:13	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\wfc6setup.exe
7	1	0	https://blabla.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/22/2025 6:53	3/22/2025 6:53	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\Zoom_cm_ft8sigz58845f0v4kiz9vvr2
8	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/23/2025 10:40	3/23/2025 10:40	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\360T5_Setup_11.0.0.1178.exe
9	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/25/2025 18:13	3/25/2025 18:13	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\Lec1.CS604.pptx
10	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/25/2025 18:13	3/25/2025 18:13	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\Lec2.CS604.pptx
11	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/25/2025 18:13	3/25/2025 18:13	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\Lec3.CS604.pptx
12	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/28/2025 1:46	3/28/2025 1:46	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\Lec4.CS604.pptx
13	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	3/28/2025 1:46	3/28/2025 1:46	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\Lec5.CS604.pptx
14	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/x-msdownload	4/4/2025 0:26	4/4/2025 0:26	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\DUTY ROSTER APRIL 2025.docx
15	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/pdf	4/4/2025 0:26	4/4/2025 0:26	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\DUTY ROSTER APRIL 2025.pdf
16	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/pdf	4/4/2025 0:26	4/4/2025 0:26	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\DUTY ROSTER APRIL 2025 (1).docx
17	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/pdf	4/4/2025 0:26	4/4/2025 0:26	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\DUTY ROSTER APRIL 2025 (1).pdf
18	1	0	https://www.application/...	application/pdf	4/8/2025 15:33	4/8/2025 15:33	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\Introduction to STATISTICAL THEOR
19	1	0	https://www.image/jpeg	image/jpeg	4/8/2025 15:33	4/8/2025 15:33	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\WhatsApp Image 2025-04-08 at 5:55
20	1	0	https://www.image/jpeg	image/jpeg	4/8/2025 15:33	4/8/2025 15:33	C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Downloads\WhatsApp Image 2025-04-08 at 6:00

```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
PS C:\Windows\system32> Get-FileHash "C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\Forensics\Browser\Default\Login Data" -Algorithm SHA256

Algorithm      Hash
-----
SHA256         3B78098CCE5575C2A08897158E949C8487AEBF05F02D2BA1673C5791B8D44E43
C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\F...

PS C:\Windows\system32> Get-FileHash "C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\Forensics\Browser\Default\Network\Cookies" -Algorithm SHA256

Algorithm      Hash
-----
SHA256         2A392489CD87156E038811832F3BB48796FD8DD89D7C30ADDDE2D2A30AFCCB5
C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\F...

PS C:\Windows\system32> Get-FileHash "C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\Forensics\Browser\Default\History" -Algorithm SHA256

Algorithm      Hash
-----
SHA256         B6659409982A84AB41C8754E713EA3FC212262046DDA889509D94608B5F9AA51
C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\F...

PS C:\Windows\system32>
```

Figure 7 – File Hash Verification

03 | Cookies Analysis

The cookie analysis revealed the presence of session, authentication, and tracking data across multiple domains.

Observations

- session / token / id cookies — indicate login persistence, user identification, session tracking
- Long-expiry cookies — suggest persistent login sessions and long-term tracking mechanisms
- Third-party / tracking cookies — cross-site tracking, analytics, and advertising activity

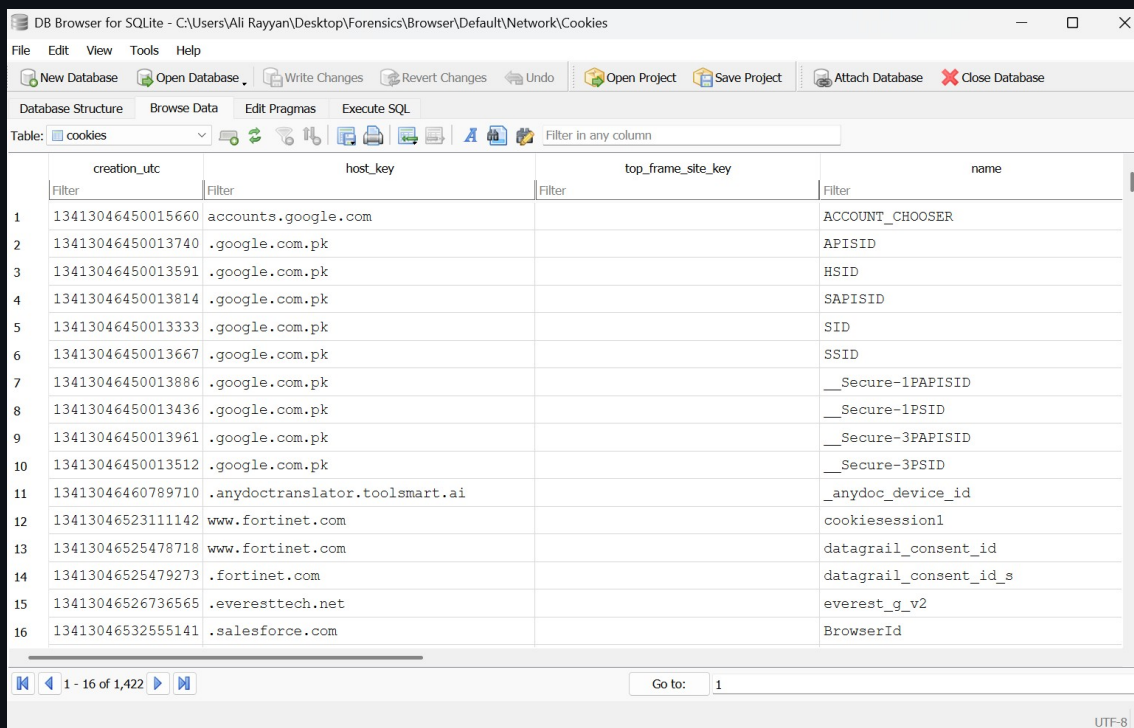
Suspicious Indicators

Some cookies were flagged due to long or complex value strings, unusual domain structures, and extended expiry durations.

Assessment

No direct evidence of malicious cookie activity was identified. Most cookies correspond to legitimate services such as Google, social platforms, and web applications. However, the data reflects extensive tracking and persistent session storage.

Evidence Screenshots



	creation_utc	host_key	top_frame_site_key	name
1	13413046450015660	accounts.google.com		ACCOUNT_CHOOSER
2	13413046450013740	.google.com.pk		APISID
3	13413046450013591	.google.com.pk		HSID
4	13413046450013814	.google.com.pk		SAPISID
5	13413046450013333	.google.com.pk		SID
6	13413046450013667	.google.com.pk		SSID
7	13413046450013886	.google.com.pk		__Secure-1PAPISID
8	13413046450013436	.google.com.pk		__Secure-1PSID
9	13413046450013961	.google.com.pk		__Secure-3PAPISID
10	13413046450013512	.google.com.pk		__Secure-3PSID
11	13413046460789710	.anydoctranslator.toolsmart.ai		_anydoc_device_id
12	13413046523111142	www.fortinet.com		cookiesession1
13	13413046525478718	www.fortinet.com		datagrail_consent_id
14	13413046525479273	.fortinet.com		datagrail_consent_id_s
15	13413046526736565	.everesttech.net		everest_g_v2
16	13413046532555141	.salesforce.com		BrowserId

Figure 8 – Cookies Overview

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K
1	host_key	name	is_secure	is_persister	expire_utc_readable						
2	.docs.google.com	OSID	1	1	6/2/2027 8:53						
3	accounts.google.com	LSID	1	1	6/2/2027 8:53						
4	accounts.google.com	__Host-1PLSID	1	1	6/2/2027 8:53						
5	accounts.google.com	__Host-3PLSID	1	1	6/2/2027 8:53						
6	accounts.google.com	__Host-GAPS	1	1	6/2/2027 8:53						
7	.docs.google.com	__Secure-OSID	1	1	6/2/2027 8:53						
8	.chromewebstore.google.com	_ga_KHZNC1Q6K0	0	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
9	.researchgate.net	_ga_4P31SI70EJ	0	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
10	chromewebstore.google.com	OSID	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
11	chromewebstore.google.com	__Secure-OSID	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
12	.researchgate.net	_ga	0	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
13	.aip.org	hum_aipp_synced	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
14	.aip.hum.works	hum_aipp_visitor	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
15	.cisa.gov	_ga	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
16	.www.researchgate.net	ptc	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
17	.aip.org	_ga	0	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
18	.aip.org	_ga_N9Z0RY7XEN	0	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
19	.ambientdsp.com	_aUID	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
20	.ijert.org	_ga	0	1	6/1/2027 5:06						
21	.ladsp.com	lum	1	1	6/1/2027 5:06						

Figure 9 – Cookies Sorted by Expiry Date

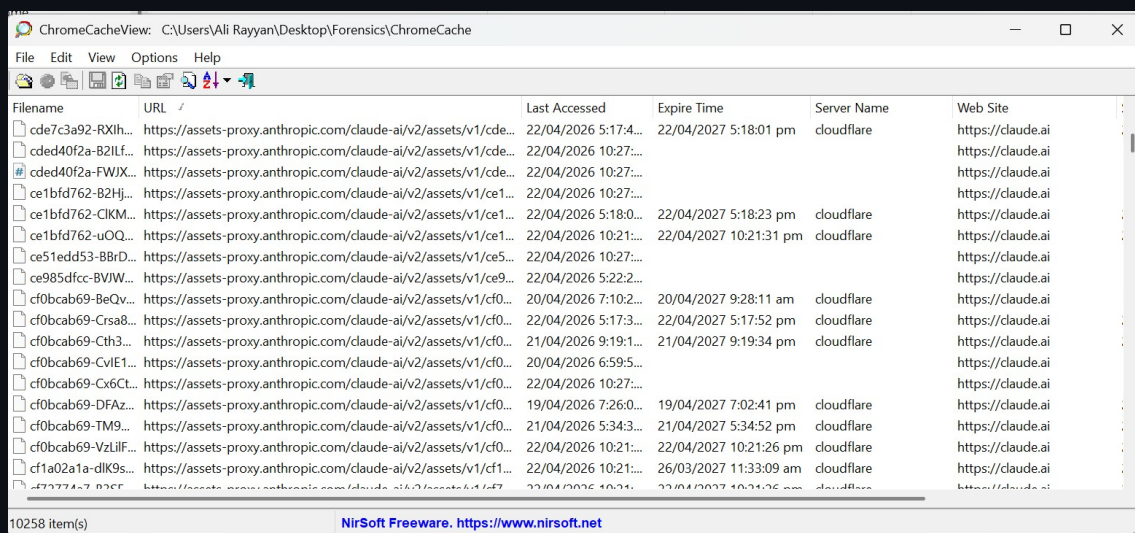
04 | Cache Analysis

Cache analysis identified web resources associated with Google Meet, GitHub, and LinkedIn. The presence of JavaScript, CSS, and API-related files confirms that these websites were fully loaded and actively used.

Media files related to Google Meet further indicate participation in online meetings. The cache artifacts validate browsing history findings by confirming that web pages were not only visited but also rendered and interacted with.

Assessment: No suspicious or malicious content was identified in the cache. All cached resources correspond to well-known and trusted platforms.

Evidence Screenshot



The screenshot displays the ChromeCacheView application window, which is a tool used for analyzing web browser caches. The window title is "ChromeCacheView: C:\Users\Ali Rayyan\Desktop\Forensics\ChromeCache". The application shows a list of 10258 items, with the first 15 items visible in the table below.

Filename	URL	Last Accessed	Expire Time	Server Name	Web Site
cde7c3a92-RXlh...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cde...	22/04/2026 5:17:4...	22/04/2027 5:18:01 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cded40f2a-B2ILf...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cde...	22/04/2026 10:27...			https://claude.ai
cded40f2a-FWJX...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cde...	22/04/2026 10:27...			https://claude.ai
ce1bfd762-B2Hj...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/ce1...	22/04/2026 10:27...			https://claude.ai
ce1bfd762-CKM...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/ce1...	22/04/2026 5:18:0...	22/04/2027 5:18:23 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
ce1bfd762-uOQ...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/ce1...	22/04/2026 10:21...	22/04/2027 10:21:31 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
ce51edd53-BBrD...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/ce5...	22/04/2026 10:27...			https://claude.ai
ce985dfcc-BVJW...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/ce9...	22/04/2026 5:22:2...			https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-BeQv...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	20/04/2026 7:10:2...	20/04/2027 9:28:11 am	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-Crsa8...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	22/04/2026 5:17:3...	22/04/2027 5:17:52 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-Cth3...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	21/04/2026 9:19:1...	21/04/2027 9:19:34 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-CvIE1...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	20/04/2026 6:59:5...			https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-Cx6CT...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	22/04/2026 10:27...			https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-DFAz...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	19/04/2026 7:26:0...	19/04/2027 7:02:41 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-TM9...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	21/04/2026 5:34:3...	21/04/2027 5:34:52 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cf0bcab69-VzLiF...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf0...	22/04/2026 10:21...	22/04/2027 10:21:26 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cf1a02a1a-dIK9s...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf1...	22/04/2026 10:21...	26/03/2027 11:33:09 am	cloudflare	https://claude.ai
cf7377457-B2CF...	https://assets-proxy.anthropic.com/claude-ai/v2/assets/v1/cf7...	22/04/2026 10:21...	22/04/2027 10:21:26 pm	cloudflare	https://claude.ai

Figure 10 – Cache Contents Overview

05 | LNK File Analysis

LNK file analysis was conducted to reconstruct file access activity on the system. Shortcut artifacts were examined to identify file execution paths, access timestamps, and storage origins.

The analysis revealed that all accessed files originated from the local system. The identified file paths were primarily located within user directories such as Downloads and Desktop. The accessed files included document formats (PDF and text files) as well as outputs related to forensic tools.

The DriveType field consistently indicated fixed storage media, and the Volume Serial Number remained uniform across all entries. This confirms that all file access activity was performed on the internal storage device, with no evidence of removable media usage.

Temporal Analysis

Analysis of the SourceAccessed timestamps indicates that file access events occurred within a relatively narrow time window, suggesting a focused and continuous session of activity rather than sporadic or irregular access patterns. No evidence of unusual access times (such as late-night or off-hours activity) was observed.

File Characteristics

The filenames and directory structures do not indicate the presence of unknown or suspicious files. All accessed files appear consistent with normal user activity and forensic-related work. No executable files or artifacts originating from temporary, hidden, or suspicious directories were identified.

Forensic Insight

LNK artifacts persist independently of the original files and can provide evidence of file access even if the original file has been deleted or moved. In this case, no missing or anomalous file references were observed.

Conclusion

The LNK analysis indicates normal and legitimate user behaviour. All file access activity was confined to the local system and aligns with expected usage patterns, including document handling and forensic analysis work.

- No indicators of malicious activity
- No unauthorized access detected
- No external storage (USB) usage identified
- No network-based file interaction observed

Evidence Screenshots

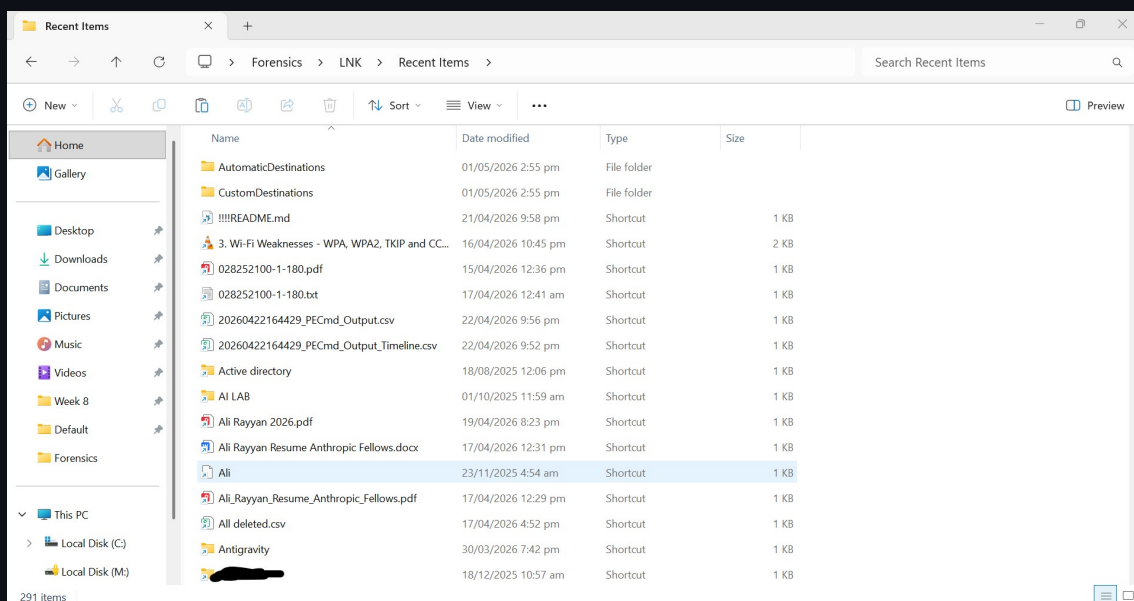


Figure 11 – LNK Files Collected (291 Items)

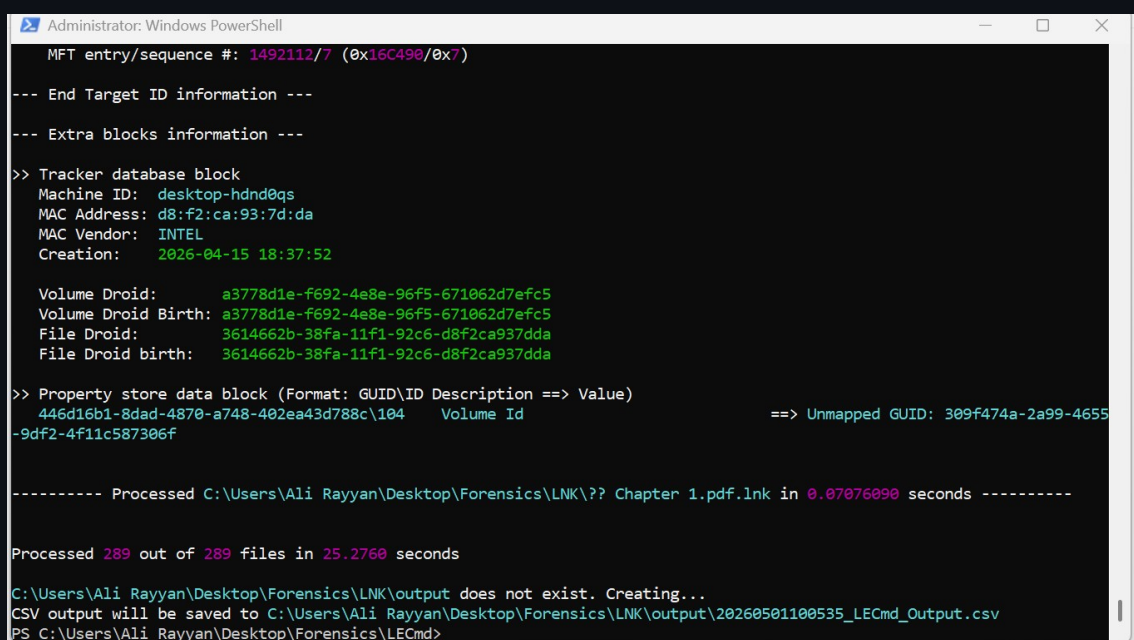


Figure 12 – LECmd Parsed LNK Output

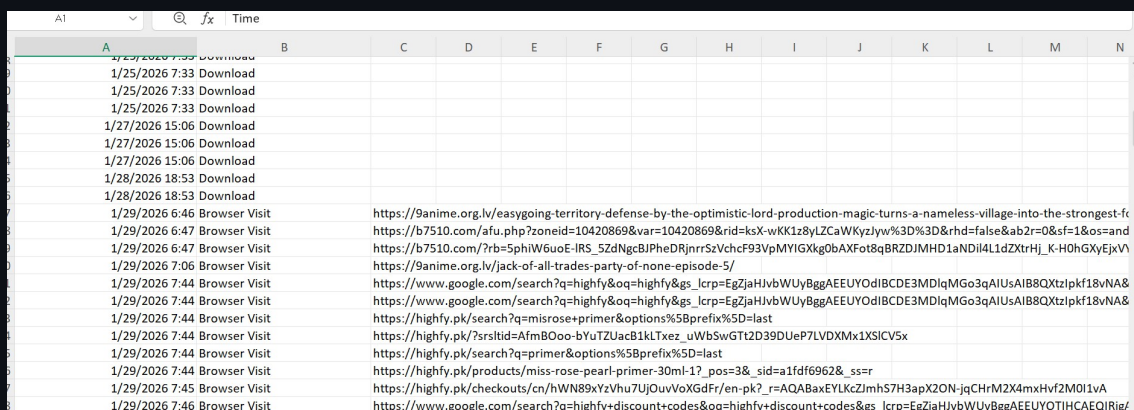


Figure 13 – Master Timeline View

06 | Final Summary & Conclusion

Artifact	Status	Key Findings
Browser History	✓ Clean	Mixed productive + entertainment usage; no malicious domains
Downloads	■ Review	.exe/.zip files and missing entries flagged for verification
Cookies	■ Monitor	Extensive tracking; persistent sessions; no malicious indicators
Cache	✓ Clean	Confirms active use of trusted platforms (Meet, GitHub, LinkedIn)
LNK Files	✓ Clean	All access confined to local storage; single focused session

Overall Conclusion

The digital forensic investigation, based on the analysis of browser history, downloads, cookies, cache, and LNK artifacts, reveals a coherent and consistent pattern of normal user activity without evidence of compromise or malicious intent.

The activity begins with browser usage, where the user accessed a combination of productivity and communication platforms alongside entertainment websites. The cache analysis further supports this behaviour by showing fully loaded resources from trusted platforms. Following browsing activity, the downloads analysis shows that the user saved a variety of files, primarily documents, images, and standard formats. A small number of compressed and executable files were identified and flagged for review, though no direct evidence of malicious activity was found.

The cookies analysis indicates the presence of session and tracking data consistent with widely used services. LNK artifacts confirm all file access was localised to the internal hard drive within a single structured session, with no evidence of removable media or network-based file access.

Verdict: Correlating all evidence sources, the investigation presents a consistent narrative of normal user behaviour involving productive and recreational activities, followed by localised file access and forensic analysis work. **No significant indicators of compromise, unauthorized access, or anomalous system behaviour were identified** within the scope of the analyzed artifacts. Minor elements (executable downloads, tracking cookies) represent common patterns in typical system usage and do not independently indicate malicious activity.

Note: Forensic analysis is inherently limited to available data sources. The absence of evidence should not be interpreted as definitive proof of absence of malicious activity.